

Investor call takeaway “2027F a turning point” Quick Note

We hosted an investor call for LG Energy Solution (LGES) on 1-2 October, during which management projected continued strong growth momentum driven by energy storage system (ESS) expansion while maintaining cautious optimism on EV recovery.

For LGES, we think the turnaround will likely emerge from early-2027F ([link](#)). 2H26F earnings will likely be subdued as it is undergoing reforming/optimizing for its US plants to produce ESS. Our positive investment thesis for LG ES is based on: 1) sizeable US advanced manufacturing tax credit (AMPC) of KRW1.3tn/1.8tn in 2026F/27F to support operating margins of 2.6%/5.9%; 2) global ESS capacity expansion to 60GWh (US: 50GWh) by end-2026 (2025: global 35GWh; US 20GWh) to generate a revenue of KRW8.5tn (+204% y-y) in 2026F; and 3) a strong EV battery customer profile. We estimate 2026F revenue mix at 38%/28%/30% for the EV/ESS/cylindrical segment. We summarize key takeaways from the call below:

Maintain 3Q26E guidance; 3Q26E revenue to increase 20% q-q

LG ES maintained its 3Q26E revenue guidance of +20% q-q and operating margins to record low-mid single digit including AMPC tax credit. Excluding the AMPC, LG ES expects to record losses in 3Q26E. Management highlighted an increase in revenue will stem from +40% q-q ESS revenue growth, while EV revenue growth of high teens q-q will likely come from the EU market. The company expects ESS business to record above BEP level (excluding AMPC) by the end of 2026E.

US ESS ramp-up on track; LG ES securing 30% of m/s in US ESS market

LG ES expects its 50GWh US ESS capacity by the end of 2026E to fully ramp up and produce 40GWh of output in 2027E. The company expects 30+GWh of US ESS shipments in 2026E (1H26: 10GWh, 2H26E: 20+GWh), implying a ~30% US market share based on 90GWh of US ESS demand. LG ES' competitiveness lies in its ESS technology and local production capacity. Utility companies using LG ES' ESS batteries will be eligible for ITC tax credit up to 40%, which provides price competitiveness to China players.

Management guided that the company will not make preemptive measures to expand the ESS capacity in the US beyond 2028. LG ES' US ESS capacity will reach 70GWh by the end of 2027E, and further expansion can be possible in its Ontario plant (excess capacity: 20GWh).

Progress toward commercialization of next-generation battery technologies

- Sodium batteries: Sample cell production is targeted for end-2026, with pipelines for EV applications in China and ESS applications in Korea, while LG ES is targeting US as a key target market.
- All-solid-state: LG ES is targeting humanoid robots and premium EVs, with mass production expected beyond 2030E. Management sees the technology initially targeting niche applications given its higher cost, despite advantages in safety and energy density.
- BBU (Battery Backup Unit): The company has already modified an existing Korean cylindrical line for BBU applications. Management targets potential business progress by early-2027E. The BBU market offers attractive profitability (low-mid teens margins) while volume contribution to remain relatively small compared to EV cylindrical batteries.

Rating Remains	Buy
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Target price Remains	KRW 560,000
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Closing price 30 September 2026	KRW 357,000
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Fig. 1: LGES – quarterly forecasts

(KRWbn)	1Q25	2Q25	3Q25	4Q25	2025	1Q26	2Q26	3Q26F	4Q26F	2026F
Sales	6,723	6,056	6,065	6,474	25,319	6,555	7,560	8,784	7,392	30,291
EV Battery	4,135	3,618	3,363	2,764	13,879	2,884	3,024	3,175	2,350	11,433
ESS Battery	439	373	559	1,413	2,783	1,383	1,951	2,646	2,470	8,450
Small Battery	1,692	1,575	1,778	1,965	7,010	2,098	2,344	2,578	2,057	9,077
Others (1x items)	458	491	366	333	1,647	190	241	386	515	1,331
Operating profit	375	492	601	(122)	1,346	(208)	113	343	545	794
% margin	5.6%	8.1%	9.9%	-1.9%	5.3%	-3.2%	1.5%	3.9%	7.4%	2.6%
EV Battery	(100)	(90)	67	(499)	(622)	(252)	(198)	(31)	(90)	(572)
ESS Battery	(90)	(45)	28	(113)	(220)	(249)	(117)	(140)	(4)	(510)
Small Battery	107	136	141	157	541	104	187	129	124	545
IRA AMPC, others	458	491	366	333	1,647	190	241	386	515	1,331
Recurring profit	365	(27)	553	(476)	414	(859)	(128)	443	557	14
% margin	5.4%	-0.4%	9.1%	-7.4%	1.6%	-13.1%	-1.7%	5.0%	7.5%	0.0%
After-tax profit	227	91	536	(772)	81	(944)	(329)	390	893	11
% margin	3.4%	1.5%	8.8%	-11.9%	0.3%	-14.4%	-4.4%	4.4%	12.1%	0.0%

Note: 1) AMPC is included in revenue due to change in accounting method; 2) After-tax profit before considering minority interest

Source: Company data, Nomura estimates

Appendix A-1

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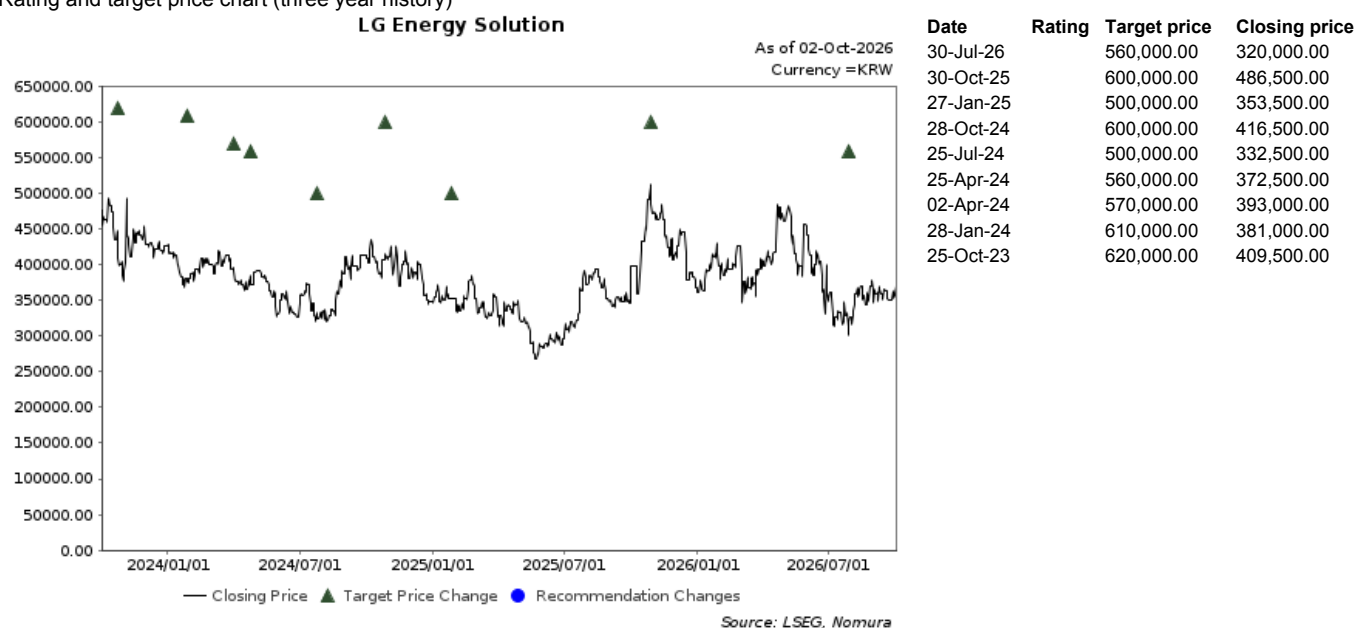
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Issuer	Ticker	Price	Price date	Stock rating	Sector rating	Disclosures
LG Energy Solution	373220 KS	KRW 357,000	30-Sep-2026	Buy	N/A	

LG Energy Solution (373220 KS)

KRW 357,000 (30-Sep-2026) Buy (Sector rating: N/A)

Rating and target price chart (three year history)



For explanation of ratings refer to the stock rating keys located after chart(s)

Valuation Methodology Our TP of KRW560,000 is based on a DCF model, assuming: 1) cumulative IRA tax credit (AMPC) of KRW11.3tn over 2026-30F ; 2) an ASP decline of 4% p.a. over 2026-35F; 3) a consolidated shipment increase of 14% p.a. over 2026-35F; 4) an increase in EV/ESS/small-size battery capacity to 266GWh/271GWh/130GWh by 2035F (2026F: 150GWh/60GWh /90GWh).

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